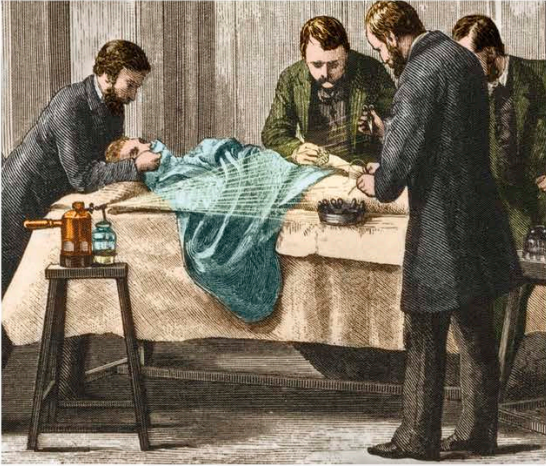


▼ ANTISEPTICS

Until the 1860s, surgeons did not clean operating tables or equipment because they were unaware of the role of bacteria in causing infections. As a result of these unhygienic conditions, death rates among patients were very high. In 1867, British surgeon Joseph Lister discovered that carbolic acid killed bacteria. He sprayed his medical instruments with this antiseptic and reduced death rates of his patients from 46 percent to 15 percent.

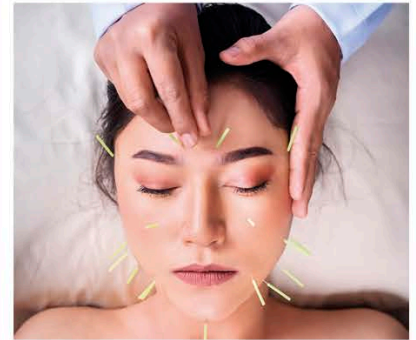


▲ X-RAYS

In 1895, German physicist Wilhelm Röntgen discovered a new form of radiation that could pass through the human body, and produce an image of its interior. Unable to identify it, he called it the X-ray. His discovery revolutionized medical diagnosis, as doctors could now look inside the human body.

TAKE A LOOK

Until the 20th century, the people of China relied on traditional Chinese medicine techniques. Acupuncture is one such technique that is still studied and practiced today, where needles are inserted into pressure points in the skin to relieve pain, cure disease, and improve health. Many people in China still opt for traditional medicine treatments, along with Western medicine.



1750–1900

